

Giving someone the installer

How to build the setup file, how to get it to a clinic PC, and what the person there has to do.

1. Build it

From the repository root, on a machine with the .NET SDK:

```
powershell -ExecutionPolicy Bypass -File scripts\make-installer.ps1
```

Takes two or three minutes, most of it compressing. You get one file:

```
C:\HMS\Setup\TwinkleHMSSetup.exe      about 67 MB
```

That is the whole thing. There is no folder to copy alongside it.

To put it somewhere else:

```
powershell -ExecutionPolicy Bypass -File scripts\make-installer.ps1 -OutputDir D:\Handover
```

The version comes from the project, not the script. `<Version>` in `src/Pharma.App/Pharma.App.csproj` is what the sidebar shows and what Add or remove programs lists. Bump it before building a release, or two different builds will both call themselves 1.0.0.

2. Get it to the clinic

67 MB is too big for most mail systems, so in practice:

- **A pen drive.** Simplest, and it works with no internet at the clinic.
- **OneDrive, Google Drive or WeTransfer.** Share a link, let them download it.

Either way, tell them the file will be flagged — see the next section — because otherwise the first thing they meet is a warning that looks like a virus alert.

Nothing else needs to go with it. Not the .NET runtime, not Visual C++, not the database. The runtime is inside the file and the database is created on first launch.

3. What the person at the clinic does

1. **Copy TwinkleHMSSetup.exe to the desktop.** Running it straight off a pen drive works, but from the desktop it is easier to find again.

2. **If it came from the internet, unblock it first.** Right-click the file → **Properties** → tick **Unblock** at the bottom → **OK**. Windows marks anything downloaded, and without this the install can fail with no useful message. A file that arrived on a pen drive is usually not marked.
3. **Double-click it.**
4. **Windows will say the publisher is unknown.** Click **More info**, then **Run anyway**. This is expected: the file is not code-signed. See [Signing](#) below.
5. **Answer Yes** to "Install Twinkle Children's Hospital on this PC?"
6. **Answer Yes to the Windows administrator prompt.** The installer needs it once, to write to `C:\` and to register the entry under Add or remove programs. If the person using the PC is not an administrator, someone who is has to do this step.
7. Wait for **"Twinkle is installed. There is a shortcut on the desktop."**
8. **Open it from the desktop shortcut.** The first launch creates the database and can take a few seconds longer than usual.

4. What it puts on the machine

Path	What it is
<code>C:\HMS\App\TwinkleHMS.exe</code>	The application. The only program file
<code>C:\HMS\DB\</code>	The database. Never touched by an install
<code>C:\HMS\DBBackup\</code>	A copy taken each day the application is opened
<code>C:\HMS\Logs\</code>	Activity logs, rolled daily, capped at 10 MB
Desktop and Start menu	Shortcuts, for all users of the PC
Add or remove programs	An entry with an uninstaller

5. Setting the clinic up on first run

Once it opens, in this order:

1. **Settings** → **Shop details**. The clinic name, address, phone, GSTIN, drug licence number and pharmacist. Everything here prints on every bill, receipt and prescription, so it is worth getting right before the first sale.
2. **Settings** → **Doctors**. At least one, or no visit can be booked.
3. **Medicines**, then **Inventory** — or **Inventory** → **Import supplier bill** if there is a supplier file to load.

The [user guide](#) covers all of this properly.

6. Installing a newer version

Exactly the same steps. Build a new setup file, carry it over, run it.

- The program is **replaced**.
- `C:\HMS\DB`, `C:\HMS\DBBackup` and `C:\HMS\Logs` are **left alone**. This is the whole reason the database does not live beside the executable.
- **Twinkle must be closed**. The installer stops with "*Twinkle is open. Close it and run this again*" rather than failing partway through on a locked file.

Take a backup before updating anyway — **Settings** → **Back up now** — and copy `C:\HMS\DBBackup` to a pen drive. It costs a minute.

7. Removing it

Settings → **Apps** → **Installed apps** → **Twinkle Children's Hospital** → **Uninstall**.

That removes the program, the shortcuts and the Add or remove programs entry.

It deliberately leaves `C:\HMS\DB` behind. Uninstalling the software should never be what destroys a clinic's records. Delete that folder by hand if the data really is meant to go — and take a copy first.

8. When it goes wrong

What you see	What it is
"Windows protected your PC"	Not signed. More info → Run anyway
Nothing happens on double-click	The file is blocked. Properties → Unblock
"Twinkle is open. Close it and run this again"	Exactly that. Close it, including from the system tray
Administrator prompt never appears, install fails	The account is not an administrator. Someone who is has to run it
Antivirus quarantines the file	An unsigned self-extracting exe is a common false positive. Allow it, or sign the file
It installs but will not open	<code>C:\HMS\Logs</code> has the reason. The last few lines are usually enough

Signing

The setup file is not code-signed, which is why Windows calls the publisher unknown and why antivirus is occasionally suspicious of it.

For one or two clinics, telling people to click **Run anyway** is workable. For wider distribution it is worth buying a code-signing certificate and signing both `TwinkleHMS.exe` and `TwinkleHMSSetup.exe` — the warnings go away and SmartScreen stops interrupting.

The other two ways to publish

Both still work and are still in the repository. Neither replaces the setup file for handing to someone else.

`scripts/publish.ps1` — publishes straight into `C:\HMS\App` on *this* machine and makes a desktop shortcut. For the development PC, not for handover.

ClickOnce (`src/Pharma.App/Properties/PublishProfiles/ClickOnceProfile.pubxml`) — publish from Visual Studio, or:

```
msbuild src\Pharma.App\Pharma.App.csproj -t:Publish -p:PublishProfile=ClickOnceProfile -p:Configuration=Release
```

It produces `setup.exe`, `TwinkleHMS.application` and an `Application Files` folder in `src\Pharma.App\bin\publish`. **All three have to travel together** — the `setup.exe` is only a bootstrapper and fails on its own, which is why it is not what we hand over. Its real strength is automatic updates from a shared folder, which is worth revisiting if the clinic ever has more than one PC.